

2026 MSA Strategic Initiatives

Superseded: the active cycle is now the **2027 call** (deadline: November 1, 2026, 11:59 PM ET), which adds a sixth area of emphasis on collection/preservation of microscopy knowledge. Full draft: [2027_msa_strategic_initiatives_proposal.md](#).

Working document for a CALIBER proposal to the [Microscopy Society of America \(MSA\) Strategic Initiatives program](#) 2026 call. The call funds bold, innovative new programs (not continuations of established ones) that increase or disseminate knowledge in the science and practice of microscopy, imaging, and compositional analysis, or in related instrumentation.

2026 areas of emphasis (from the call)

- Novel initiatives that promote student involvement in microscopy
- MSA-branded dissemination of information regarding new advances in microscopy, microanalysis, and image analysis
- Enhancement of member benefits leading to retention of members
- Leadership training/mentorship to provide future leaders for MSA and the field of microscopy
- Initiating or enhancing academic, governmental, and industrial partnerships (excluding microscopy vendors and vendors of microscopy-related products) in microscopy application and development

Proposal outline (draft)

1. Summary: CALIBER as a literature- and physics-grounded platform for selecting high-fidelity SEM, EDS, EBSD, and XRF acquisition parameters for novel alloys
2. Target area(s) of emphasis
3. Team, partners, and reviewers
4. Budget and timeline
5. Deliverables and success metrics